Wish Fulfillment

By David Simpatico

ONE

The Son rocks. The Father enters holding his drink.

FATHER: Your mother said you wanted to talk to me.

SON: Dad. I got something I need to tell you.

FATHER: What is it.

SON: Mom already knows.

FATHER: What is it.

SON: This is not easy for me.

FATHER: What is it.

SON: Uhm . . . DAD I'M GAY. *(They don't move. They stare at each other in tense silence. Slowly, the Father cracks into a mask of tears, sobbing pitifully.)* Daddy-

(The Father rises, walks around the chair and starts the scene again.)

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 1: *Now more than ever, gays and lesbians are coming out to their parents-and they're doing it when they're quite young.*
ACTOR 2: *But sometimes it is best to stay in the closet—and here's why.*
ACTOR 1: *Despite the evidence that Americans are getting more tolerant of gay and lesbian people, some parents still reject their children when they come out— ejecting them from their homes . . .*
ACTOR 2: *Some even react with violence.*
ACTOR 1: *Other parents may feel as if their children have died*
ACTOR 2: *Wish Fulfillment by David Simpatico provides audiences with a wide range of reactions when a son tells his father that he is gay.*
ACTOR 1: *Where would you fall in this spectrum?*
ACTOR 2: *How would you react if your son shared this most intimate part of himself with you?*
TOGETHER: *Wish Fulfillment by David Simpatico.*

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TWO

The Son rocks. The Father enters holding his drink.

FATHER: Your mother said you wanted to talk to me.

SON: Dad. I got something I need to tell you.

FATHER: What is it.

SON: Mom already knows.

FATHER: What is it.

SON: This is not easy for me.

FATHER: Yes-

SON: Uhml . . . DAD I'M GAY.

FATHER: Is that all? I always thought you might be, ever since you were little. I'm glad you finally feel comfortable enough about your sexuality that you can admit it to yourself Your mother and I just want you to be happy.

SON: Wow.

FATHER: And healthy. Do you practice safe sex?

SON: Absolutely.

FATHER: Well then. As long as you're happy, that's all that matters.

SON: I don't know what to say.

FATHER: You've already said it.

SON: But you're being so cool.

FATHER: Hey now, don't sell your father short. Just because I personally don't ascribe to your sexual orientation, I would never have the pomposity to morally condemn something simply because it is out of the realm of my own personal experience.

SON: Wow. When I grow up, I want to be just like you.

FATHER: I just want you to be happy. Your father loves you. *(They are about to embrace, but they start the scene again.)*

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THREE

The Son rocks. The Father enters, holding his drink.

FATHER: Your mother said you wanted to talk to me.

SON: Dad. I got something I need to tell you.

FATHER: What is it.

SON: Mom already knows.

FATHER: What is it.

SON: Uhm ... Dad, I'm gay. *(The Father spits out his drink in a violent spume of disbelief, sopping his son with his double scotch. They start the scene again.)*

FOUR

The Son rocks. The Father enters with a new drink.

FATHER: Your mother said you wanted to talk to me.

SON: Dad. I got something I need to tell you.

FATHER: What is it.

SON: Mom already knows.

FATHER: What is it.

SON: This is not easy for me. I mean I - Dad, I'm gay. *(The Father's drink dribbles out of his mouth.)* Dad- *(The Father clutches his heart, suffers a massive coronary, collapses to the floor shaking in agony. The Son races to his father's side, alternately pounding on his chest and giving him mouth-to-mouth)* No-Daddy please don't die, it's all my fault, I didn't mean it, I'll change, I was kidding--don't die Daddy please don't die-Daddy please- *(With a final horrific shudder, the Father dies.)* I'VE KILLED MY FATHER! *(He throws himself weeping across his father's corpse. They start the scene again.)*

FIVE

The Son rocks in his chair. The Father enters, holding his drink.

FATHER: Your mother said you wanted to talk to me.

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SON: Dad. I got something I need to tell you.

FATHER: What is it.

SON: Mom already knows.

FATHER: What is it.

SON: This is not easy for me. Uhm I. . . . DAD, I'M GAY.

(A tense beat of stillness. Suddenly, the Father takes out a gun. Shoots his son in the head. The Son does a backward tumble out of the chair and shakes in postmortem frenzy. The Father methodically empties the gun into his son's body. They start the scene again.)

SIX

The Son rocks. The Father enters, holding his drink.

FATHER: Your mother said you wanted to talk to me.

SON: Dad. I got something I need to tell you.

FATHER: What is it.

SON: Mom already knows.

FATHER: What is it.

SON: It's hard, Dad. . . . What I have to tell you.

FATHER: WHAT IS IT!

SON: Can you please stop yelling at me-

FATHER: I AM NOT YELLING--

SON: YES YOU ARE TOO YOU'RE ALWAYS YELLING I CAN'T STAND IT ANYMORE JUST STOP YELLING FOR CHRIST'S SAKE--

FATHER: What the hell did you want to tell me already--

SON: NONE OF YOUR STUPID BUSINESS OK, GET OFF MY BACK AND LEAVE ME ALONE ALL YOU EVER DO IS YELL AT ME MY WHOLE LIFE WHY CAN'T WE JUST TALK --

FATHER: DON'T YOU EVER TALK TO YOUR FATHER LIKE THAT, I DON'T CARE HOW BIG YOU ARE I AM STILL YOUR FATHER DO YOU UNDERSTAND ME *(Slaps*

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him.) DO YOU UNDERSTAND ME *(Slaps him.)* DO YOU UNDERSTAND ME *(Slaps him.) (The Son shakes his head "Yes") (Gently.)* Now what did you want to tell me? *(They start the scene again.)*

SEVEN

The Son rocks. The Father enters, holding his drink.

FATHER: Your mother said you wanted to talk to me.

SON: Dad. I got something I need to tell you.

FATHER: What is it?

SON: I love you Dad.

FATHER: What did you want to talk about?

SON: Do you love me?

FATHER: Is this what you wanted to talk about?

SON: Do you love me, Dad?

FATHER: I'm your father. Yes, I love you.

SON: No matter what.

FATHER: What is it?

SON: Well, Dad, I'm gay. *(Silence.)*

FATHER: I don't want to hear this. *(They start the scene again.)*

EIGHT

The Son rocks. The Father enters, holding his drink.

FATHER: Your mother said you wanted to talk to me.

SON: Dad, I'm gay.

FATHER: I don't want to hear this.

SON: Well I am. I'm gay.

FATHER: I don't want to hear this. You just told me the worst thing in the world.

SON: Thanks Dad. You still love me?

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FATHER: Don't ask me that like I'm on trial here.

SON: It's a simple question.

FATHER: You just threw a brick in my face.

SON: Do you still love me?

FATHER: You will always be a part of this family, but in my honest opinion, you belong on the other side of the street in the gutter with the freaks.

SON: So I'm a freak.

FATHER: You're being honest, I'm being honest.

SON: You just called your son a freak.

FATHER: You don't like the truth.

SON: You just threw a brick in my face.

FATHER: Truth hurts don't it.

SON: Do you still love me?

FATHER: You're my son.

SON: I thought I was a freak. *(They start the scene again.)*

NINE

The Son rocks. The Father enters, holding his drink.

FATHER: Your mother said you wanted to talk to me.

SON: I'm gay Dad.

FATHER: You can get help you know. *(They start the scene again.)*

TEN

The Son rocks. The Father enters.

FATHER: Your mother said you wanted to talk to me.

SON: Dad. I got something I need to tell you.

FATHER: What is it.

SON: Mom already knows.

FATHER: What is it.

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SON: This is not easy for me.

FATHER: You can tell me I'm your father. I love you.

SON: Well Dad I'm gay.

FATHER: I'm sorry, what?

SON: I said I'm gay.

FATHER: As in Homosexual.

SON: As in Homosexual. *(They jump up, face off.)*

FATHER: I thought I knew you.

SON: You do know me. Now you know.

FATHER: No I don't.

SON: Why because I'm gay?

FATHER: No, because you're a goddamn freak that's gonna wind up dead in the gutter at the end of a two-by-four because someday soon you're gonna pinch the wrong behind and he's gonna turn around and rip the eye right outta your friggen head and I hope to God I'm there to see it, goddamn AIDS carrier- *(Swings, wings his son.)*

SON: I am not an AIDS carrier-

FATHER: You're a goddamn faggot is what you are and all faggots are AIDS carriers- *(Slams, just missing his son's skull.)*

SON: I knew you'd be upset.

FATHER: How the hell are you gonna be happy

SON: How is anyone happy . . . how are you happy-

FATHER: Oh but I am not happy. *(Swing and a miss.)* I used to think I was happy but see I used to think I kinda knew my son, *(Swing and a miss.)* I used to think I had something in common with the boy I raised. *(Swing and a miss.)* I used to think I could teach him something and maybe someday see a little part of me growing

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up inside of him.

SON: There's a lot of you in me.

FATHER: Don't tell me *that!*- *(Swings, knocking his son to the floor.)* I never even suspected-

SON: *(Slowly rising.)* So what were you seeing? I mean I'm lost here, Dad, if me telling you that I'm gay changes everything, then what was there before that's going to change. You're letting one part of who I am completely change who I was so tell me, really, who was I, who were you seeing all that time that you don't see now-

FATHER: I gotta be honest I got no idea and that's what scares me it's like I'm looking at a big blank like the past twenty years means nothing like all the sweat and blood and worry I put into raising you means nothing like you're spitting in my face and telling me it's all my fault and I should smile and accept and I am sorry kiddo but just because you got my blood in your veins don't mean I got to stand back watchin' while you piss on everything I built my life around-I am telling you I will not accept!

SON: *(Approaching him.)* Daddy-

FATHER: I WILL NOT ACCEPT - I am so humiliated my whole life means nothing without a son I can't be a father so who the hell am I and who are you I want my son back and it's all my fault *(They start the scene again.)*

ELEVEN

The Son rocks. The Father enters.

FATHER: Your mother said you wanted to talk to--

SON: You stopped loving me when I was three years old and you came home from work and I ran up and hugged your legs because I was so happy to see Daddy because Daddy was so big and so strong and so tall and Daddy always brought home a candy bar hiding in his pocket and so I grabbed it but instead I grabbed

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you didn't I, Daddy, and you knocked me down and beat me black-and-blue didn't you Daddy because I was three years old and I had to learn never to touch another man because it was sick and bad and from that second on you wouldn't even let me hug you because you wanted me to be normal and well-adjusted so you kept pushing me away and pushing me away because you were too scared to let me hug you again -

FATHER: I was just trying to be a good father-

SON: You think this is easy for *me*-

FATHER: How are you gonna be happy-

SON: How is anyone happy how are you *happy*-

FATHER: Oh but I am not happy.

SON: Well neither am I. I'm looking back on my life and all I see is a big blank, I don't know who you are Dad what did we ever talk about I can't remember and I want my father back because I feel like I wasn't there, like I was always pretending, sitting around smiling and being the good boy and all the time about to explode with a deep dark perverted secret that no one could understand and made me a freak in the eyes of God and so I became a freak and lived like a freak and treated myself like a freak so I could live up to your expectations drowning in the sewer but I can't live by your rules anymore because I am exploding now and I can't stop and I want my life back and I want to be happy because I am not a freak, Daddy, do you understand me, I am not a freak-

FATHER: It's all my fault-

SON: t's nobody's fault Dad It's not good and it's not bad, it just is-and it is about me, it is not about you-stop being so self-centered and think about what I'm telling you and what I'm going through because I am the one who is going through it, not you, and I need love right now . . . understand, I need love-

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FATHER: I wanted to teach you how to fight.

SON: Well you did a good job because that's all I know how to do –

FATHER: *(Feebly on his knees.)* Your father loves you-

SON: *NO . . .* I don't know who you are-I have no father. I have only myself. *(They start the scene again.)*

TWELVE

The Son rocks in his chair. The Father enters, holding his drink.

FATHER: Your mother said you wanted to talk to me. *(Silence. They say nothing.)*

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

2003 National Qualifier
2004 National Qualifier
2006 National Qualifier
2010 National Qualifier
2013 National Qualifier
2015 National Qualifier
2019 National Qualifier
IL State Qualifier

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